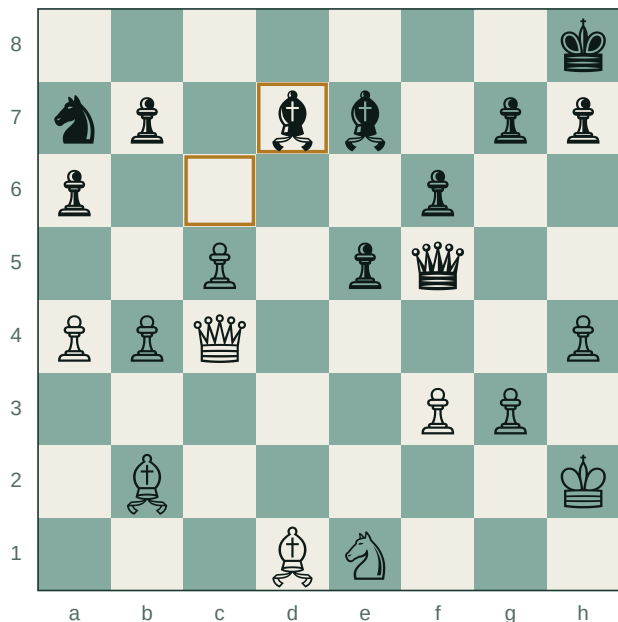


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 30

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 29...Bd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Bb3 Qh3+ 31. Kg1 Be6 32. Qxe6 Qxe6 33. Bxe6

30.Bb3 The bishop moves from d1 to b3. Recorded reply: **30...Qh3+**.

31.Kg1 The king moves from h2 to g1. Recorded reply: **31...Be6**.

32.Qxe6 The queen captures the bishop on e6. From e6 it attacks queen on h3 and bishop on e7. Recorded reply: **32...Qxe6**.

33.Bxe6 The bishop captures the queen on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e7 and knight on a7. Check for tactical protection.